



Summer Analytics 2026 – Capstone Project

Sustainability Project: Decarbonizing Travel

The following information and associated data are fictional and purely for educational purposes. This scenario does not reflect Celonis' internal travel policy and documentation nor do the datasets contain real employee information.

Our Mission and Responsibility

At Celonis, we believe in doing business that is good for people, companies, and the planet. With our process intelligence products, we have the unique opportunity to help businesses run more efficiently and sustainably. Together, we can tackle the biggest challenge of our generation by acting today for a more sustainable tomorrow.

Since starting in Munich, we have grown significantly, establishing major centers in New York, Madrid, Bangalore, and beyond. While we are proud of our innovative culture and worldwide reach, this growth brings an increased focus on our carbon footprint and sustainability commitments.

Road to Net Zero by 2030

We have committed to an ambitious goal to lower our carbon emissions to be Net Zero by 2030. Our internal analysis indicates that the bulk of our Scope 3 carbon emissions stems from employee business travel.

What are Scope 3 Emissions? Scope 3 emissions are indirect greenhouse gas emissions that occur in a company's value chain. Unlike Scope 1 (direct emissions from owned sources) or Scope 2 (emissions from purchased electricity), Scope 3 includes activities from assets not owned or controlled by us, such as the flights, trains, and hotels our employees use for business travel.

Currently, our travel booking process is decentralized. While this has historically prioritized cost savings and employee convenience, we now see an opportunity to integrate carbon efficiency into the heart of our travel operations. We are looking to evolve our processes by:



- **Integrating Carbon Metrics:** Incorporating emission data directly into the booking and approval workflow.
- **Enhancing Automation:** Increasing the automation rate for policy checks to ensure sustainable choices are made consistently.
- **Driving Transparency:** Creating a clear system of carbon accounting to track, measure, and report on our performance.

We believe Celonis is the best tool to identify a dynamic strategy for efficient decarbonization in a high-growth business environment. Our goal is to prioritize the reduction of high-emission travel while maintaining the agility of our global teams.

Strategic Objectives for Investigation

Value Discovery

This project aims to showcase the dollar value behind sustainable travel through:

- **Quantitative Metrics:** Identifying cost savings through "quick wins" like shifting from flights to trains or petrol cars to EVs.
- **Qualitative Metrics:** Enhancing brand leadership and driving transparency in carbon accounting.
- **Operational Efficiency:** Optimizing approval workflows to prevent last-minute, high-emission bookings.

Focus Areas for Analysis

To help us achieve our Net Zero goal, consider the following focus areas:

1. **Carbon Leadership & Patterns:** How can we analyze individual travel choices and policy exception rates to identify patterns of carbon leadership and areas for improvement?
2. **Regional Benchmarking:** How do travel processes compare across North America, Europe and Asia in terms of carbon efficiency? Which region offers the greatest potential for impactful reduction?

3. **Low-Carbon Alternatives:** Which travel routes and modes of transport (e.g., switching from flights to trains or petrol cars to EVs) represent "quick wins" or high-impact long-term investment opportunities?
 4. **Streamlining Approvals:** How can we optimize the approval workflow to prevent last-minute, high-emission bookings? Where can automation best support carbon-based decision-making?
 5. **Business Unit Impact:** Which Business Units (e.g., Sales vs. Engineering) or travel purposes (e.g., Customer Visits vs. Internal Trips) are the primary drivers of emissions?
 6. **Sustainable Growth:** As we continue to expand globally, what strategies should we implement to offset the natural increase in emissions associated with a larger operation?
 7. **Future Value:** What are the long-term benefits of carbon-friendly travel, and how will the importance of these "victories" evolve over the next three years?
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Key Business Questions

At a minimum, your solution must address all five of the following questions to satisfy executive stakeholders. Failure to address any one of these will result in disqualification from the Top 10 selection.

1. **Emissions Profile:** What does our current carbon footprint look like in terms of total emissions?
 2. **Regional Benchmarking:** How do processes compare across North America, Europe and Asia?
 3. **Hotspot Identification:** Is there a particular region, Business Unit (e.g., Sales vs. Engineering), or travel purpose with disproportionately high output?
 4. **Pain point identification:** Identify the inefficiencies and pain points as analysed in the data
 5. **Actionable Recommendations:** What specific updates should be made to travel policies and what value will it generate in three years
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Final Presentation

The Executive Pitch

The final presentation should be treated as a consultant's pitch to executives. Executives expect a structured narrative. The final pitch must include a live demo featuring the Process & Variant Explorers and at least three distinct dashboard tabs (Views) which contain at least five Celonis data analysis components such as KPI cards, graphs, tables, and more.

- **Slides:** Clearly articulate value, findings, and actionable insights.
- **Live Demo:** A functional walkthrough of dashboards within the Celonis environment.
- **KPIs:** Include tracked metrics such as total costs per business unit, emissions by region, and opportunities for sustainable growth.

The complete pitch should not exceed more than **10 minutes**. This will be followed by a **5 minute Q&A**.

Delivery Tips

- Open with impact, not an introduction — skip "Hi, I am X or we are Team Y." Jump straight into: *"Celonis spent \$X on business travel last year. Y% of it was avoidable."*
- Skip the problem statement – focus on why decarbonizing travel is critical to Celonis
- Decide where to move fast and where to slow down – judges don't need every detail
- If you are presenting as a team, assign roles before the day — decide who speaks for each section; fumbling handoffs lose time and credibility
- Rehearse to time at least twice
- Keep answers to **90 seconds max** — judges appreciate conciseness

First Round Deliverable Components:

- **Executive Summary Slide (mandatory):** Highlight the total emission, your top 3 insights, top 3 recommendations, and the projected impact. This will be used for initial



shortlisting. Also include your view on why decarbonizing travel is critical to Celonis' emissions reduction targets for 2030.

- **Presentation slides (mandatory):** Emissions Profile & Benchmarking, Hotspot Analysis, Inefficiencies Identified, Low-Carbon Recommendations (quantified), Strategic Integration Roadmap
- **Dashboard demo screenshots::** Additional slides to show the 3 dashboard tabs. This will be used for initial shortlisting.

The total slide deck must be between 7 and 10 slides, including the title, mandatory content slides, and a maximum of 3 dashboard screenshot slides.

Required Dashboard (View) Tab Naming in the platform

To enable efficient reviewer comparison, use the following standard tab names:

- Tab 1: Emissions Overview
- Tab 2: Benchmarking
- Tab 3: Emissions Drilldown

Additional tabs are welcome but these three are mandatory.

Evaluation Criteria & Scoring Rubric

All submissions will be scored on a 1–5 scale per criterion by independent reviewers. Scores will be aggregated to produce a final ranking for Top 10 selection.

Criterion	Weight	What Reviewers Look For
Ideation & Creativity	20%	Innovativeness of proposed sustainability solutions; originality of insight
Technical Skills	20%	Proficiency in data integration, analytical view and development



Productization	25%	Identification of target business segments; clearly defined success metrics for the tool
Stakeholder Communication	25%	Clarity and persuasiveness when defending assumptions; quality of executive narrative
Part B – High Carbon Score Task 10%	10%	

Scoring Scale:

- 5 – Exceptional: Exceeds expectations with strong evidence and depth
- 4 – Strong: Clearly meets expectations with good supporting detail
- 3 – Satisfactory: Meets basic expectations
- 2 – Developing: Partially meets expectations with gaps
- 1 – Insufficient: Does not meet expectations

Bonus Points (up to 10% additional score)

Teams can earn bonus points for exceptional work in any of the following areas:

- External benchmarking data incorporated (e.g., GHG Protocol, IATA industry averages)
- Predictive or forward-looking analysis (emissions trajectory to 2030)
- AI solutions suggested or implemented (need not be Celonis centric)

Submission Checklist

Before submitting, confirm you or your team has included:

- Process & Variant Explorer
- A minimum of 3 distinct dashboard tabs (Views) in the Celonis environment
- A minimum of 5 Celonis data analysis components (KPI cards, graphs, tables, etc.)
- All 5 Key Business Questions addressed
- A "Results at a Glance" slide in the presentation



- Quantified recommendations (e.g., "Switching Route X to rail saves Y kg CO₂ and \$Z per year")
 - Slide deck within the 7–10 slide limit
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Submission Instructions

- Submit your slide deck (PDF or PowerPoint) via the program submission portal
- Submissions are due by the deadline communicated by your program coordinator
- Teams must also complete the Phase 1 Gate Checklist as a separate form submission
- Slide deck must be titled: [TeamName]_SummerAnalytics_Sustainability

Important: All recommendations must be quantified. Vague recommendations such as "reduce flights" will not score well. Instead, state: "Replacing the Munich–Frankfurt route with rail travel would reduce emissions by X kg CO₂ and save \$Y annually."